

A Brie Grows in Brooklyn

"Mabel's not crazy... she's unusual."

POSTS LIKES ASK ME ANYTHING SUBMIT ARCHIVE

On Rage and Motherhood

There was this article in [the New York Times about the rage mothers feel but don't talk about it](#), I talk about it, yo! I found out my sister's baby daddy tried to submit my blog as evidence in my niece's custody hearing yesterday, so when I talk about it, I'm jeopardizing lives, yo. The really frustrating thing to me about reading personal essays that get a lot of traction is that in my opinion, I write better personal essays, that use less cliches, but yet, here I am, publishing on Tumblr, a site no one uses anymore.



Last week was a week of real rage for me. People keep on telling me that having two kids gets easier and easier. Also some people tell me it never gets easier. I completely forgot that at 9 months, babies become fucking needy, howling, cranky scream boxes. In my case, Cass can almost walk, but not quite, and if I try to put him down anywhere for even a second results in him completely losing his shit. Last week, he had a temperature for 3 days. He was screaming so much that I thought his intestine might be blocked, so I took him to the doctor, who confirmed that he has a common cold. Man colds are real, tho.

The screaming is really a tough thing to deal with. If you don't have children, ask someone you love to scream at you continuously for five minutes and then dare yourself not to punch them. This morning, someone screamed on the street at 5:20am, and I'm so used to my kids screaming that I thought one of them had escaped from the house. It takes about 20 minutes of screaming for me to really lose my shit, and then I do things that I am ridiculously ashamed of. Like tell the baby to "shut the fuck up." In front of my toddler. Even writing that I do this, I feel so much shame. I also wonder if my sister's baby daddy already saw me do this because I'm pretty convinced he has hacked into our smart tv, and is recording us.

Anyway, I lose my shit very quickly, and then recover. I kiss Cass a million times, and tell him I love him. I strap him to my chest. I give Cleo a lollipop, and a chocolate, and my right pinky toe on a plate, and whatever else she wants, so that she'll put on her shoes. I take them outside. Being outside immediately makes me feel better. It makes Cass stop screaming. Usually my toddler has only agreed to leave with our dog, who lunges and bites every fucking person who passes us. And we live in a densely populated city, so it's a lot of people. Somehow, dealing with the dog parking and lunging, my toddler screaming at people, "Don't stare at me," and the general approbation of the public is like 1,000 percent less stressful than being stuck in a box with a screaming baby.



The thing is, I don't feel that guilty (in retrospect) about the rage. I've come to accept that rage is natural, and that suppressing it by telling women that it's wrong is one of many ways society holds us down. I don't drink, I don't smoke, I feed my children organic food, I spend all but 18 hours a week with them, I read to them, I limit their screen time, I love them, I kiss them, I sleep with them, I care for them when they're sick. I play with them, I draw with them, I'm sending the toddler to a fucking French pre-school. I'm using the full force of my sterling education to imbue culture upon them. I don't take secret benzodiazepems or hit a vape pen when I take them to the park. I could not be a more fucking upright mother, and I still feel rage, as I'm sure have all mothers throughout history, from time to time, and I don't feel guilty for it. When I get mad at the kids, or I cry, sometimes it resets them, and sometimes it makes them laugh, and sometimes it's bewildering. But they never feel unsafe because of it, and they never feel unloved. I don't hit them, and drag out the rage for hours, or days. I apologize, and I explain what I felt, and why. And I hope that by showing them that I also have emotions, that I express emotions, it gives them tools to deal with the natural rage, anxiety, and despair they will feel throughout their lives. They are, after all, my genetic offspring.

Unfortunately my husband is not my genetic offspring, and when I unleash rage upon him, usually it leads to a healthy dose of rage shot back at me, which bounces back and forth between us until we both get exhausted. Then we watch a television show and eat some chocolate.

This may get me in trouble, but I get my bad temper from my father. My father is Mr. Nice Guy to strangers, and especially those who society perceives as lesser, like the homeless. Approach my dad smelling like BO with your toes sticking out of your shoes, and he will find out your life story, and treat you like his equal. But cut my father off on the highway, and he will practically whine from the intensity of the rage that fills his body. Growing up, I was never afraid of my father's rages. In fact, I screamed right back at him. My father's rages were short, and harmless. My father is a good person, in his soul. He has a lot of kindness. If he hurts you, he apologizes for it, unless you do something sexually inappropriate, then he's afraid to look at you.

What I think I'm trying to say is that my father's rage was, if anything, something I loved about him? Because rather than being this stand up gentleman all of the time who loves the tired and the poor, sometimes, if you backed your car into a tree, he would lie prostate on the ground, like a Muslim in prayer, and scream at the top of his lungs. And honestly, that was fucking funny.

So hopefully my kids feel the same about me one day. That I'm funny. And also ultimately kind. And also, human.

As usual, I'm ending this post by not ending it.

#Rage #Motherhood
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